

used for the initialisation and execution of tasks at specific times and based on other specific events. generally, `/etc/crontab` will provide `cron` with a list of the tasks it needs to run, also known as cronjobs, and the `/var/cron/tabs` provide detailed scheduling data.

In `cron`, the configuration takes place through two different types of files. The first is known as the system crontab. These files are pre-included in `cron` and should not be tampered with under any circumstances. These files contain a WHO tab, which specifies the type of user the file is 'run as'. The second type of file is known as the user crontab. This file is always created and run by the user. It does not contain a WHO tab and is always run by the user who creates it.

```

^_ (escape) menu ^y search prompt ^k delete line ^p prev li ^g prev page
^o ascii code ^x search ^l undelete line ^n next li ^v next page
^u end of file ^a begin of line ^w delete word ^b back 1 char
^t top of text ^e end of line ^r restore word ^f forward 1 char
^c command ^d delete char ^j undelete char ^z next word
=====line 6 col 13 lines from top 4=====
SHELL=/bin/sh
PATH=/etc:/bin:/sbin:/usr/bin:/usr/sbin
#
#minute hour      mday      month      wday       who        command
#
*/5      *      *      *      *      root       /usr/libexec/atrun
*        */2      *      *      *      root       sh /root/download.sh
#
# Save some entropy so that /dev/random can re-seed on boot.
*/11     *      *      *      *      operator   /usr/libexec/save-entropy
#
# Rotate log files every hour, if necessary.
0        *      *      *      *      root       newsyslog
#
# Perform daily/weekly/monthly maintenance.
1        3      *      *      *      root       periodic daily
15       4      *      *      6      root       periodic weekly

```

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crontab in FreeBSD

Here are the main features of entries in a crontab:

- When a line begins with a #, it is logged as a comment.
- Environment settings are defined using the = sign.
- To define different fields in the same line, press tab after every field.
- Similarly, to define the values for these fields, press tab after every value in the order in which the fields were defined.

Next we will see an example of such code.